

NORTHFIELD & VALE RETAIL GROUP

Quarterly Customer Complaint Summary

Product Line: Home & Kitchen | Quarter: Q2 2024 (Apr-Jun) | Prepared by: Customer

Experience Analytics Team | Date Issued: July 10, 2024

1. SUMMARY

The Home & Kitchen product line received 287 complaints in Q2 2024, down 6% from Q1 2024 (305 complaints). The decrease follows corrective action taken on the CopperCraft cookware set after a Q1 spike in coating-related complaints.

2. COMPLAINT VOLUME BY CATEGORY

- Product defect / malfunction: 94 complaints (33%)
- Missing parts or accessories: 71 complaints (25%)
- Shipping damage (dented boxes, cracked ceramic): 58 complaints (20%)
- Difficulty with returns/refund processing: 39 complaints (14%)
- Misleading product description: 25 complaints (8%)

3. TOP PRODUCTS BY COMPLAINT COUNT

1. HearthGlow 6-Quart Slow Cooker - 62 complaints. Most common issue: lid seal failing to maintain pressure, causing uneven cooking. 2. CopperCraft 10-Piece Cookware Set - 41 complaints. Most common issue: non-stick coating flaking after approximately 3 months of regular use. 3. BrewMaster Drip Coffee Maker - 38 complaints. Most common issue: carafe leaking at the base during brewing cycle. 4. LinenLoft Bedding Bundle - 34 complaints. Most common issue: missing pillowcases in 4-piece sets shipped between April 10 and May 2. 5. GrindWell Manual Coffee Grinder - 22 complaints. Most common issue: burr mechanism jamming with coarser grind settings.

4. REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

Midwest region stores accounted for 31% of complaints, followed by South (28%), Northeast (24%), and West (17%). The Midwest concentration correlates with a regional promotional push on the HearthGlow slow cooker during Mother's Day.

5. RESOLUTION METRICS

- Average time to resolution: 3.6 days (target: 5 days)
- Complaints resolved via replacement unit: 48%
- Complaints resolved via refund: 37%
- Complaints resolved via store credit: 15%
- Customer satisfaction score post-resolution (CSAT): 4.0 / 5.0

6. ROOT CAUSE NOTES

The CopperCraft coating issue identified in Q1 has been traced to a supplier change in the non-stick coating formulation introduced in December 2023. The supplier has reverted to the prior formulation effective May 2024, and early indicators show a downward trend in related complaints for units manufactured after that date. The LinenLoft missing-pillowcase issue was traced to a packaging line error at the distribution center and has been corrected.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Continue monitoring CopperCraft complaint trend through Q3 to confirm formulation fix is effective.
- Redesign HearthGlow lid gasket; engineering sample expected by August 2024.
- Conduct a full packaging audit at the distribution center following the LinenLoft incident.
- Add grind-setting guidance to GrindWell product packaging insert.

This report is confidential and intended for internal distribution to Category Management, Engineering, and Executive Leadership only.